

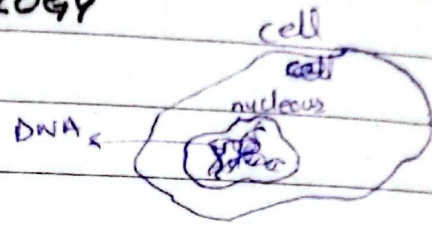
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BASICS OF BIOLOGY

① Cell

- ↳ The basic unit of life
- ↳ Each Cell has a structure, performs function contains DNA.
- ↳ Each cell has a different kind of function, How does a cell know which func to perform?
 - ↳ DNA tells it. (like an instuction manual)



② DNA (Deoxyribonucleic Acid)

- ↳ DNA is found inside the nucleus of a cell
 - ↳ Brain of a cell
- ↳ It is a long molecule that stores biological instruction

• Structure of DNA

- ↳ DNA is made up of nucleotides.

↳ Nucleotides are building blocks or "letters" of DNA

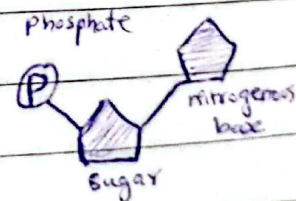
- ↳ Each nucleotide has 3 parts

① Sugar

② Phosphate Group

③ Nitrogenous Base - 4 types

- i- Adenine (A) iii- cytosine (C)
- ii- Thymine (T) iv- Guanine (G)

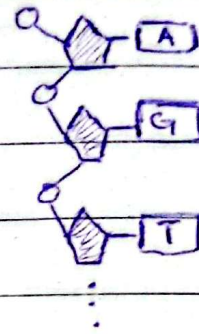


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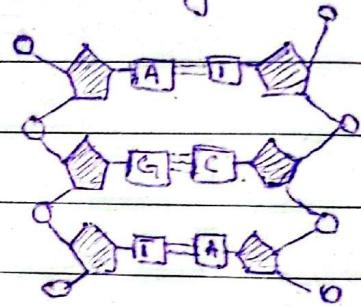
► A single DNA strand

↳ Many nucleotides join together through phosphate-sugar bonds to form a single strand of DNA



► Double Helix - Classic DNA Shape

↳ DNA is double-stranded, meaning there are two single strands twisted around each other



10 RULE

→ A only pairs with T

→ C only pairs with G

→ This is called a base pair

Strand 1: A T G C → DNA sequence

Strand 2: T A C G

↳ If we have one strand then we can easily know the other

→ Each human cell contains 46 strands of DNA

→ DNA is extremely long — millions of letters

→ It stays inside the nucleus of a cell

→ For sequence lengths we use

Kb → kilo-bases

Gb → Giga bases

Mb → Mega-bases

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▷ Amino Acid

- ↳ Amino acid are small chemicals in the body
- ↳ They are called "building blocks of life"
- ↳ They are about 20 diff & types
- ↳ Each has unique shape
- ↳ They connect together like legos
- ↳ Amino acid forms → proteins

▷ Proteins → Protein is also represented by string of letters.
Each letter is an amino acid which comes thru codon.

- ↳ Proteins are made of chains of amino acid
- ↳ There are millions of diff proteins
- ↳ Protein must be fold into correct shape to work properly
- ↳ If shape is wrong → protein will not function

Amino Acid → Protein → Cells → Tissues → Organs

▷ How Does DNA Works?

- ↳ DNA has many functions
- ↳ One of its main function is to tell amino acids how to line up to make proteins
- ↳ If the right proteins are made at the right time and right place
- ↳ Cells work properly
- ↳ Organs form

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▷ DNA → RNA → Protein

- ↳ DNA cannot leave nucleus
- ↳ But it has to instruct amino acid for correct formation of protein
- ↳ Amino acid is in Cytoplasm
↳ Area outside nucleus
- ↳ Special chemicals make a partial copy of DNA called RNA (Ribonucleic Acid)
- ↳ RNA is shorter than DNA
 - ↳ It is single stranded
 - ↳ RNA leaves the nucleus thru tiny pores
 - ↳ RNA uses U (Uracil) instead of T.
- ↳ RNA goes to a structure called Ribosomes
- ↳ Ribosomes are protein building machine
- ↳ Ribosomes reads RNA 3 letters at a time
 - ↳ Every 3 letters = one amino acid instruction
 - ↳ Codons (mentioned later in notes)

▷ What is a Gene.

- ↳ A gene is a special segment of DNA
- ↳ It is a specific sequence of A, T, C, & G.
- ↳ A gene is not the entire DNA strand
- ↳ It is just a small section of DNA
- ↳ Genes makes protein
- ↳ One DNA strand contains thousands of genes
- ↳ Humans have about 20,000 genes in total

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↳ Gene size varies

↳ Some are only 300 letters long

↳ " " " over 1 million " " .

↳ The length and sequence determine

↳ Protein size, Protein shape, Protein function

↳ Different Organisms have diff genes, diff protein recipes

But,

All life uses the same DNA language (A, T, C, G)

▷ Chromosomes

↳ DNA is extremely long

↳ To fit inside the cell, it is tightly packed into structures called chromosomes

↳ ~~DNA~~ Misconception:

DNA is not stored inside a chromosome

Instead: The Chromosome ITSELF is the DNA, tightly wrapped

↳ Humans have 23 pairs of chromosomes

↳ 46 total in each cell

↳ For each pair 1 chromosome comes from mother & another from father.

↳ Together these make up genome

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- Genome is a complete set of DNA inside a cell of organism.
- Almost every cell in your body already contains full copy of your genome
- But different cells turn diff genes ON or OFF

→ Example:

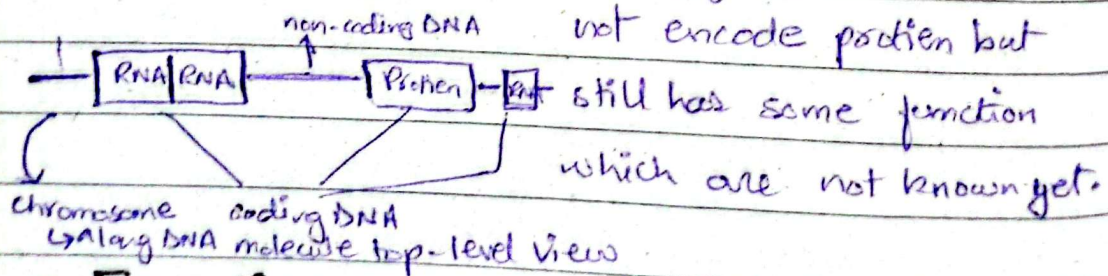
- ↳ Eye cells use eye-related genes
- ↳ Liver " " liver " "
- ↳ and so on.

→ This is called gene regulation

↳ Genome comprises the coding & non-coding genetic sequence, cDNA (coding DNA)

↳ Coding Sequence — Part of genome that encodes protein

↳ Non-coding " — Part of genome that does not encode protein but



→ Encoding

↳ The sequence of DNA bases determines the sequence of amino acids in a protein.

→ A protein string A E F F Q P (each alphabet is called residue)

→ A codon tells amino acid how to line up to form protein

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↳ Every 3 DNA bases = 1 amino acids

↳ Example:

- A DNA bases ATG codes for amino acid Methionine
- This 3-base unit is called a **codon**

DNA	RNA
→ Long and usually double stranded	→ Short & often single stranded
→ Trapped inside the nucleus	→ Active all throughout the cell
→ Relatively stable	→ Relatively High Fragile
→ Guarded & Repaired when damaged	→ Digested & rebuilt when damaged
→ Used for information storage	→ Used for active functions such as protein coding
→ Base pair has TH T	→ It has U (Uracil)

→ As 3-base unit forms → 1 amino acid so it mean we should have

$4 \times 4 \times 4 = 64$ combination of codons
 A/C/G/T A/C/G/T A/C/G/T so 64 Amino acids But in

reality there are only **20** amino acids. (because we have some redundancies & special cases)

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Q How to determine start & end of a gene in a DNA sequence?

↳ The cell knows exactly from where a gene starts & end.

↳ There are specific codons that determine the start of Gene.

Start : ATG (DNA) / AUG (RNA)

↳ codes for Methionine

End : TAA, TAG, TGA

↳ They donot code for any protein.

↳ When ribosome sees these codon, protein synthesis stops